

(European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁰. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged.

The action should result in (A) the identification of policy options at EU level (including those to address possible legislation gaps) and practical ways to support the work of relevant stakeholders notably the ethics committees and integrity bodies. The European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity⁶¹ should be a main reference.

The work undertaken should also result in (B) operational (“how-to”) guidelines to support the work of research teams.

The need to complement the European Code⁶² with specific guidelines should be assessed and a proposal (C) for short documents complementing the Code should be made, focusing for example on fast track processes (ethics review, publication etc.).

In addition, this action should produce (D) traditional and online training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. Case studies (for example on mobile tracing apps) should be included in order to facilitate practical learning. The material, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶³. Where relevant the EU Digital education plan⁶⁴ should be taken into account.

Although the main focus should be on the recent Covid-19 pandemic, it is also important to have in mind the wider objective of addressing the ethics of global crisis of the same kind (manmade or not). The action should in this regard present a generalised version of the produced recommendations and guidelines and training material.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects⁶⁵ (e.g. SHERPA, SIENNA, Panelfit, SOP4RI) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science and the European Networks ENERI and ENRIO, with clear attribution of research ethics and research integrity responsibilities, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-91: Ensuring reliability and trust in quality of Research Ethics expertise in the context of new/emerging technologies

Specific conditions	
Expected EU	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50

⁶⁰ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶¹ http://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/h2020-ethics_code-of-conduct_en.pdf

⁶² Ibid.

⁶³ www.embassy.science

⁶⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁶⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

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<i>contribution per project</i>	million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶⁶, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁷ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁸. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Ensuring the adherence to the highest standards of research ethics is a key element of national and EU research policy. Because of its universal impact on our society and its primary role in innovation, the need for ethics rigour, the pillar of public trust in the scientific endeavour, is essential. Overall, research ethics is the foundation of high quality research and a prerequisite for achieving excellence in research and innovation in Europe and beyond.

In order to ensure that the research activities meet these expectations, they need to comply with the relevant legislations (e.g. on personal data protection, clinical trials, animal research

⁶⁶ www.embassy.science

⁶⁷ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶⁸ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

etc.) and ethics principles. Assessing the compatibility with ethics principles requires the involvement of ethics experts that usually provide, as an ethics committee/panel an opinion or an approval. These experts, including early career researchers, come from all disciplines in science, from the public and private sector, as well as from citizens associations and NGOs.

Reliability and trust in the quality and expertise of the ethics experts is therefore key. This requires beyond the questions related to the independence and the possible conflicts of interest, that the experts have the necessary knowledge and understanding of the issues at stake to be able to assess the activity under review.

The recent rapid development of new technologies with high potential socio-economic impact⁶⁹ constitutes in this regard an important challenge: ensuring that technological transformations go hand in hand with the protection and promotion of fundamental rights thus ensuring that people can prosper, enjoy their rights and freedoms and live without discrimination.⁷⁰ In this context, because of the continuous globalisation of the research activities involving those new technologies, the risk of ethics dumping, the exportation of unacceptable practices outside the EU is a growing concern.

The action proposed should address these issues in mobilising the research ethics community and develop the necessary education, awareness and training actions as well as propose possible adaptation of the ethics review process.

Scope: The first objective should be to identify the main ethics challenges resulting from the most impactful new and emerging technologies, including the specific challenges arising from research activities involving those new technologies in collaboration with non-EU partners and outside the EU.

From this analysis, the action should develop education, awareness actions and trainings for research ethics experts. This should be done by involving the key stakeholders. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁷¹ and the European networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁷² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices) is necessary. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged. In addition, where feasible these activities should be based on the analysis of case studies, including from non-EU countries where relevant research activities take place, to facilitate the development of practice-oriented trainings as well as the identification of good practices. The material produced, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available in the platform Embassy of Good Science, a one stop shop for all Commission produced ethics and research integrity reference materials

⁶⁹ Applicants may consult : https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/what-are-technologies-will-reshape-our-world-independent-experts-identify-100-them-2019-jun-13_en

⁷⁰ Presidency conclusions - The Charter of Fundamental Rights in the context of Artificial Intelligence and Digital Change, Brussels, 21 October 2020 (OR. en) 11481/20 FREMP 87 JAI 776

⁷¹ www.embassy.science

⁷² <http://eneri.eu/>

and trainings, which can be readily used by all Members States and beyond. Where relevant, the EU Digital Education Action Plan⁷³ should be taken into account.

The action should be based on the results coming from projects funded by the EU⁷⁴ on the ethics dimension of new technologies and other relevant domains (notably SIENNA, PANELFIT, SHERPA, I-CONSENT, ENERI, and TRUST) as well as benefit from the work of the project SOP4RI, working on standard operating procedures and VIRT2UE working on a train-the-trainer programme. For the ongoing projects, cooperation and synergies should be established, via a dedicated horizontal coordination work package. This work package should also pay particular attention to the cooperation with the projects resulting from call H2020-SwafS-2020-1 TechEthos, HYBRIDA and ROSiE.⁷⁵ The involvement of the stakeholders such as ENERI and ENRIO should also be used to launch a debate on the impact of the new ethics challenges on the ethics review process to determine how its role and working practices could evolve to maintain effectiveness.

In addition, this cooperation with the main actors should aim at disseminating widely the material produced. The action should in this context foresee the training of the 250-300 Horizon Europe ethics appraisal scheme experts, paying close attention to gender balance, as well as to gender equality and diversity related ethical aspects, and make use of their feedback to improve the trainings. More largely, the institutions organising ethics reviews (universities, research centres, etc.) should be invited to ensure that the experts they rely on are also trained, as part of their quality process and standard operating procedures.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising the work produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts and in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks (such as EUA, YERUN, LERU, CESAER, EARMA etc.) in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

Call - European Research Area

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)⁷⁶

⁷³ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁷⁴ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

⁷⁵ Ibid.

⁷⁶ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.
The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.